

Source Amnesia Trace Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Knowledge and the Knower • 20-30 min

Category	Knowledge and the Knower	Time	20-30 min
Difficulty	Easy	ID	source-amnesia-trace

Big idea: Remembering a claim is not the same as remembering why it deserved trust.

One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students hear claims from different sources, then later test whether they remember the claim, the source, or both.

Student Prompt

Inspect Source Amnesia Trace Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Source Amnesia Trace Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Claim: 'Spacing revision improves long-term memory' paired first with 'cognitive scientist', then later shown without source. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Source Amnesia Trace Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Claim: 'Blue light glasses double focus' paired first with 'online advert', then later shown without source. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Source Amnesia Trace Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: Claim: 'Blue light glasses double focus' paired first with 'online advert', then later shown without source. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Remembering a claim is not the same as remembering why it deserved trust.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Source Amnesia Trace Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Source Amnesia Trace Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
6	What happens to justification when we forget the source of a belief?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Knowledge and the Knower.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how remembering a claim is not the same as remembering why it deserved trust.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: What happens to justification when we forget the source of a belief?

Setup Checklist

- Pair each claim with a visibly different source label, then remove the labels for the recall phase.
- Use a short distractor task between exposure and recall so source memory has time to fade.

Example Stimuli or Materials

- Claim: 'Spacing revision improves long-term memory' paired first with 'cognitive scientist', then later shown without source.
- Claim: 'Blue light glasses double focus' paired first with 'online advert', then later shown without source.

Resources To Use

- Resource pack: <resources/source-amnesia-trace/index.html>
- Card deck CSV: <resources/source-amnesia-trace/cards.csv>
- Visual prompt: <resources/source-amnesia-trace/visual-prompt.svg>
- Source-trace answer sheet with columns: remembered claim, remembered source, confidence, revised trust.
- Source label cards: expert, textbook, friend, advert, anonymous post, personal experience.

Run Sequence

1. Show students a short set of claims, each paired with a different source type.
2. After a distractor task, give students the claims again without sources.
3. Students mark whether they remember the claim and then identify its original source.
4. Reveal the source pairings and compare content memory with source memory.

5. Debrief how source memory affects justification and responsible belief.

Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: What happens to justification when we forget the source of a belief?
- Can a claim become more or less credible in memory?
- How should knowers track where their beliefs came from?

Teacher Quick Script

- A claim can feel familiar even when its original justification has disappeared.
- What should happen to trust when source memory is weak?

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...